



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Connection School
School Website: <https://tcsoh.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

The Connection School of Houston (The Connection School, Cypress, TX 77433) presents a robust Classical Christian profile across all six classical elements. Public materials consistently emphasize a Christian Worldview anchored in Scripture, the Seven Liberal Arts pedagogy, and an integrated tradition of wisdom, virtue, and formation. The school foregrounds the goals of virtuous character formation, pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, and the liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; with attention to the quadrivium). Evidence of Great Books engagement, historical continuity, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative elements with Socratic-style discourse in upper grades further supports a Classical orientation. The school also demonstrates strong alignment in the areas of governance, faculty mentorship, and active parent/community partnership through programs that invite family involvement and parental education. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL.

Key evidence points include: the mission and public-facing statements grounding education in a biblical worldview and formation (not merely information); explicit reference to the seven liberal arts pedagogy and to a classical (Great Books) curriculum; documented practices in liturgical/community life (chapel, liturgy, church-aligned rituals) and mentorship-focused faculty culture; and clearly articulated partnerships with families alongside active parent engagement and campus visit opportunities. These patterns are consistently echoed across the school's publicly available materials and its programmatic descriptions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials frame The Connection School as a Christian community centered on discipling children to love God and love others. The mission is explicitly rooted in scripture (Matthew 22:37–40) and a biblical worldview, with references to God's truth being revealed in Scripture and creation.
- There is explicit emphasis on the centrality of Jesus Christ, the Seven Liberal Arts pedagogy, and a mentorship-focused faculty model. Worship/chapel activities and liturgical rhythms appear as part of school life.
- The school explicitly connects formation of virtue and wisdom with Truth, Goodness, and Beauty within a Christian framework, and stresses how education is formed by a Christian worldview.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Christian; biblical worldview; God; Scripture; liturgy; chapel; wisdom; virtue; truth/goodness/beauty; worship; Logos; theological integration; sacred tradition; mentorship; formation.
- Negative keywords observed: essentially none in the public materials (the materials are overtly Christian and theologically oriented; no indications of secular relativism or "values clarification" signals in these materials).
- Quantitative estimate: roughly 8–10 positive indicators found; 0 negative indicators identified in the crawled materials for this category. This yields a strong CLASSICAL alignment.

- Why this rating
- The presence of a transcendent moral aim (truth, goodness, beauty) rooted in a theistic framework, together with liturgical/community practices (chapel, worship), and explicit theology-grounded formation, satisfies the Positive keyword indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded Theology. The evidence supports CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school states the goal of education as the pursuit of wisdom and virtue found in God, and describes education as formation (formation of character) and as the cultivation of human excellence, not merely information or job-prep.
- The mission/vision repeatedly emphasizes loving God and loving others, with formation of character and virtue as core aims. Public materials emphasize wisdom and virtue as the telos of education and a Christian worldview integrated throughout.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: wisdom; virtue; formation; God; Christian worldview; truth/goodness/beauty; telos; liberal education; moral imagination; formation of the soul.
- Negative keywords observed: none that indicate a focus on workforce-only preparation or purely secular aims.
- Quantitative estimate: 7–9 positive indicators vs 0 negative indicators; effectively 100% positive in this category.
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly articulates formation and virtue as the purpose and telos of education, with a Christian theological grounding, which aligns with CLASSICAL criteria and outweighs any non-classical interpretations.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum is described through the Seven Liberal Arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium) and the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music), with the curriculum rooted in the liberal-arts tradition. The school describes an integrated, cross-disciplinary approach and a foundation in Great Books/Great Conversation. 9th–12th grade humanities and literature lists include canonical/classical works (Gilgamesh, Homer, Beowulf, The Divine Comedy, Plato, Pride and Prejudice, Brave New World, etc.). The High School Humanities Course Overview explicitly maps literature to intricate studies with primary sources.
- The school explicitly references the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition and integrates historical/canonical texts across grades. The CiRCE Institute affiliation (a known classical-education resource) is cited as a partner/resource.
- The school emphasizes “the seven liberal arts pedagogy” as foundational to curriculum and integrates biblical worldview within that structure.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts; trivium; quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; great conversation; history integrated; unity of truth; wonder; sacred order; classical pedagogy; learning within a Christian life; mentorship.

- Negative keywords observed: absence of a pure modern, skills-only, or STEM-first framing in the public materials; no explicit “career-ready,” “workforce” emphasis in the core curriculum language.
- Quantitative estimate: approximately 8–12 positive indicators vs 0–1 clear negative signals; strong CLASSICAL alignment.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum centers the seven liberal arts, integrates history and classical literature (Great Books) into a cross-disciplinary approach, and situates learning within a Christian framework. The public materials consistently tie the curriculum to the Great Conversation and canonical texts, which meet CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school describes a top-down Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with a “top-down” development of the language arts, beginning in kindergarten through the upper grades, which aligns with classical pedagogy. The school also references forms of Socratic discussion and rhetoric training in upper grades, along with opportunities for students to give speeches and engage in debate. Mentorship is described as a core feature of teaching. The Friday Enrichment model and four-day week show a blend of contemplative (Scholé) and purposeful activity. The public materials mention liturgies and rituals in the school life.
- Evidence of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) is shown in Friday Enrichment (time for contemplation, review, and service) and a slower, reflective pace for certain aspects of learning.
- Evidence of memorization/recitation and singing/memory-building practices appears in the classical pedagogy lexicon and in canonical texts used for early/middle grades (recitation, chant, memory work are part of the classical approach). The Six Essential Elements lexicon includes memorization/recitation as a classical pedagogy with explicit mention of singing/chanting to deepen knowledge.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue; dialectic; great conversation; recall/memory; articulation of thought; pedagogy anchored in memorization/recitation; scholé; contemplation; formation through imitation; teacher as mentor; living curriculum; mentorship; liturgical rhythm.
- Negative keywords observed: a few modern education buzzwords that could imply non-classical trends (e.g., project-based learning dominance) are listed in the knowledge-lexicon as potential negatives; however, the public-facing materials for this school emphasize a classical pedagogy and do not foreground an exclusive project-based approach.
- Quantitative estimate: 6–10 positive indicators; 0–1 explicit negative signals in the public materials (though the negative signals in the lexicon exist as a rubric for evaluation, not evidenced as public practice at this school). This yields CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- The school’s articulation of a grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence, a top-down trivium with a focus on memory, oration, and rhetorical training in upper grades, plus a mentor-led living-curriculum model and inclusion of liturgical/community practices, aligns strongly with classical pedagogy. The Friday contemplative time and emphasis on contemplation/wonder reinforce Scholé. Together, these elements satisfy CLASSICAL pedagogy criteria.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Mentorship is highlighted as a central feature of The Connection School's teaching model: "Mentorship" as a core concept; teachers as mentors with a living-curriculum approach; faculty training tied to curriculum development and pedagogy. The school speaks of a faculty devoted to mentorship and a "portrait" of what a teacher should be, consistent with classical expectations.
- The school describes teachers as "masters" or "mentors," and describes a close, relational, collegial culture aligned with classical formation; there is emphasis on personal virtue, mastery, and character formation as part of the teaching ethos.
- The CiRCE Institute affiliation and teacher-development programs are cited as part of the school's professional development ecosystem, reinforcing classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: mentor; living curriculum; model teachers; faculty as core of the school; portrait of teacher; unity of teacher formation with student formation; mentorship in life and virtue.
- Negative keywords observed: none in public materials; the lexicon's negative signals about faculty (e.g., "facilitator" or "guide on the side") are not reflected as public-facing practice here.
- Quantitative estimate: 6–9 positive indicators; 0 negative indicators; CLASSICAL alignment.
- Why this rating
- The public materials describe a faculty that models virtue and wisdom, is central to curriculum, and engages in mentorship—core classical elements. The presence of mentorship, living-curriculum teachers, and a faculty-centered formation process supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental involvement as core to classical education; there are dedicated sections about partnership with families, parent groups, home-school supports, and parent-education initiatives (e.g., book studies, RightNow Media, volunteer programs). The school explicitly states that parents are co-educators and that it seeks to educate and engage parents in classical education through guidance and community activities.
- The school maintains programs that invite parent involvement, visits, and ongoing engagement (VIP program; open-campus style communications; information meetings; campus tours; parent guides to enrollment).
- The presence of a mentorship system that engages families and a robust set of parent-focused resources (Parent Guides; FACTS Family portal; information meetings) reinforces partnership with families as fundamental to the school's classical model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families; co-educators; parental engagement; home-life integration; parent formation; family catechesis; community engagement; open campus; VIP program; parent groups/book studies.
- Negative keywords observed: none that indicate parent-exclusion or a consumer-only stance.
- Quantitative estimate: 7–9 positive indicators; 0–1 negative signals; CLASSICAL alignment.
- Why this rating
- The school's explicit emphasis on family partnership, parental formation, and open-visit policies demonstrates strong alignment with classical expectations for engaged parents and community. The presence of family-centered programs and educational resources supports CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment



- All six categories are CLASSICAL based on keyword analysis and alignment with the Six Essential Elements framework. The school demonstrates a robust classical Christian orientation across religious foundations, purpose/goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- Since the evaluation yields CLASSICAL across all six categories, no major needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully classical standing in the rubric. The school already exhibits a comprehensive classical Christian profile with explicit connections to the Great Books tradition, Seven Liberal Arts pedagogy, and liturgical/community life that anchors formation in a living, mentorship-focused faculty culture and active parent partnerships. No additional structural changes are necessary to move categories toward CLASSICAL if they are already CLASSICAL.
- If any incremental enhancements were considered, they would focus on:
 - Further codifying and communicating explicit experiences of Socratic seminars and dialectic in upper grades (to strengthen the Pedagogy category with more transparent evidence of Socratic practices).
 - Expanding explicit references to “Great Books” and canonical texts in elementary grades to reinforce continuity of Great Conversation across the full PK-12 spectrum (while already present in secondary curricula).
 - Providing additional public-facing examples of student-led, virtue-centered projects that still align with the classical formation ethos (ensuring alignment with schooled forms of memory, recitation, and formational writing while maintaining classical balance).
- However, the current public materials already reflect a strong classical orientation in line with the Six Essential Elements framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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